



◀ GARMIN NUVI 2565LM

Price: ₹17,600

GPS in-car Navigators

This year, we did a comparison test of the best GPS in-car navigators available in the market. The response to the test, from all the brands currently selling devices in India, was enthusiastic. The devices were even more exciting with some having a plain-Jane navigator blasting out directions as we drove around the city and then some. However, the gamut of features even the basic navigators are loaded with is quite a surprise.

Like last year, GPS navigators are still not really on the map of most consumers. From what we have been able to understand after receiving feedback from our readers, rolling down the window and asking someone for directions is still considered the safest option! Also, GPS navigators in India struggle at times because the routes, road layout and directions tend to change often – constructions, diversions, etc. to blame. This, for no fault of the device itself, hinders the precision of the overall navigation quality.

Another reason is the price of the devices themselves. The entry level ones start around ₹6,000, but the good ones are all upwards of ₹11,000. This not only creates a doubt in the consumer's mind about the necessity, but the alternative of free guidance from the auto-wallah seems a lot more enticing! Having said that, a GPS navigator is a must-have device if you travel a lot to different places, or happen travel at night where there may not be someone to ask around.

Zero1 Winner

Garmin Nuvi 2565LM

This was the best performer in our GPS navigator comparison test. We were very impressed with the

overall package offered – solid build with the rubberised back, excellent display, visually appealing user interface and possibly the best navigation quality, particularly with the precise voice commands. The maps are not the best 3D maps we have seen, despite the nuvi 2565LM costing a bit more than ₹17,500. But then again, there is no taking away the functionality of the device itself. For those of you who like to challenge yourself, there is the Eco-Drive feature that assesses your driving style and gives you an approximate fuel economy figure.

Worthy Mentions

MapmyIndia ZX250

Between the winner – the Nuvi 2565LM and MapmyIndia ZX250, the battle went down to the proverbial wire. Their build quality is very similar, and the display in both the devices is among the better ones in the entire category. Where the ZX250 takes the lead is with the quality of maps. While navigation quality is relatively similar, the Aura 3D Maps on the MapmyIndia navigator just take the navigation experience to a whole new level, unseen before. Every little elevation change is brilliantly rendered, and certain buildings and most monuments in their 3D avatar look brilliant on the map. For a classy navigation experience, this is the navigator to consider.



MapMyIndia ZX250

Price: ₹15,990



TomTom Via 125

Price: ₹15,999

TomTom Via 125

The TomTom Via 125 is the most matter of fact GPS navigator we have tested. And we appreciate that immensely. Switch it on, and you straightaway have the maps open and ready for navigation. Other features are in a sort of secondary layer, which makes this the most easy-to-use navigator. The windshield mount stand is integrated on the device itself, making it easy to store. Maps have been updated as well for better address search support. Buy this if you want a device that is ready to guide you, without you having to cajole it into doing so!